one year in Persia was. "Well" said the person he was talking to "and yourself?" "I believe I am the maddest of all" said the doctor.

Mr. Bonham starts on the 10th for England to take his child there and I am very busy helping him off. He has only six months leave of absence. Mr Abbott has arrived from Tehran to take his place. He goes by way of Trebizonde and will have an anxious journey from this place to that, with a child a year old last 30th April, only three teeth out, and not weaned. From thence he will go by way of steam to England.

Tabreez, June 4, 1845

I have at last received my dear Fathers letter of last December it was in the parcel you kindly sent me, and only arrived a few days ago with Dr Cormick's baggage. Many thanks for the radish seeds. And please thank George for the book; I cannot describe to you the extraordinary effect reading the descriptions of English scenery, has upon me; it stirs up in me that love of country which all Englishmen have so strongly, and which altho' it may sleep sometimes, awakes again with renewed intensity. Such feelings sometimes make me melancholy. But I comfort myself with the reflection that had I remained in Lancashire I should most probably have become, like most of the manufacturers, I recollect there, without an idea beyond my woollens, and perhaps have passed the few hours I was not engaged in business at some tavern, drinking; and by constant working amongst them, I should have lost my taste for everything except flannels, and I may perhaps add foot races and drink. Now when I reflect upon the position I hold here, notwithstanding my poverty and debts, both with Persians and Europeans, I can not but feel how much I have to be thankful for. Many of the latter whom I have met with here and with some of whom I have been on terms of intimacy were men who have been and will be again, moving in the first society of Europe. It is true we can not here get into the Pit at half price, nor have a good dinner at a chop-house, but I think we have many compensations for the luxuries and pleasures of European life. The other evening we were dining at Mr Abbott's. The party consisted of two Russian officers from Tiflis sent by the Govr Genl of Georgia on a mission to this Prince (one was a Prince and Colonel in the service, the other a young man and a civilian, but perhaps the most promising orientalist of the present day;[90] he has already published a very clever book on Bokhara and Turkistan, where he was on a mission shortly before Stoddard and Conolly were killed) two Russian attachés to the mission and consulate, Cormick, Cazolani and myself. Shortly after sitting down to dinner I said to

[90] This can only be Nikolai Vladimirovitch Khanykov, a member of the 1841–42 Russian mission, cf. V. Barthold, *History of the study of the Orient in Europe and Russia*. 2nd ed. Leningrad, 1925, p. 256 (in Russian).

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